New Dundee Public School - School Council Agenda/Minutes

Date: October 21st, 2024
Time: 7:10 p.m. – 8:55 p.m.

Meeting Link: http://meet.google.com/std-ummq-aoo
School Council Handbook: School Council Handbook

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1. Introductions and Attendance

- **Principal: Craig Bell**
- **Staff:**
- **Chair: Angie Hallman**
- **Co-Chair: Sarah Cherry**
- **Secretary: Melissa Kristensen**
- **Treasurer: Sarah Benn**

- **School Council:Keizo Marui, Stephanie Breitkopf, Kelly Willig**
- **Student: none**
- **Regrets: Rob Entz, Carolyn Winsborough, Melissa Battler, Tanya Eby**

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2. Welcome / Territory Acknowledgment

As we gather virtually this evening, we would like to honor the existence of the First Peoples by acknowledging that we are on the traditional land of the Anishinaabe, Haudenosaunee, and Mississauga peoples. New Dundee Public School occupies the land of the Between the Lakes Treaty from 1792. As learners, we continue to understand this place has significance to the First Peoples because of the rolling hills, forests, flat land, and the proximity to the Nith and Grand River, which is fed by the Great Lakes. Settlers need to take responsibility to continue our education and honor of the First Peoples. Let's work to honor the Dish with One Spoon covenant, a peace agreement made between the Indigenous nations before the settlers arrived. It characterizes our collective responsibility to each other and to Mother Earth. We should only take what we need and leave enough for future generations.

Election 2024/2025 School year

Running unopposed -
Angie Hallman - Chair
Sarah Cherry - Co-Chair
Melissa Kristensen - Secretary
Sarah Benn - Treasurer

- **Action Items:**

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3. Principal's Report

- **Action Items:**

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4. Staffing Update

- 4 Post-secondary students started placements today at New Dundee: Ms. Madhu (Conestoga College, DECE program) in Kindergarten (K2), Mr. Moffitt in 1/2A, Ms. Ingram in 4/5A and Mr. Steinmann in 2/3A (Wilfrid Laurier University, Bachelor of Education program). These teacher candidates will be at New Dundee for their Fall and Winter terms.
- **Action Items:**

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5. Clubs

- **Clubs/groups**: Bus Safety Patrols are trained - At least 4 - Grade 5-6 student patrollers have been assigned to every bus

- **Assemblies:** September 30th - Orange Shirt Day/Truth & Reconciliation Day -
- Presentation created by Ms. De Naeyer (Indigenous, Equity, and Human Rights rep), and facilitated along with Mr. Heer
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- **Upcoming:** Remembrance Day assembly November 11th at 1030am
    - Committee members: Mr. Mckenzie, Ms. Ferreira
    - grade 6 are going to lead the assembly
    - Kindergarten allowed at the assembly

    - Not going to invite parents directly, but won't turn away community members that reach out to come
- **Action Items:**

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6. Events, Field Trips & Initiatives

- **Terry Fox Run:** Friday, September 27th - organized by Mr. Heer
- **Orange Shirt Day:** September 30th.
- **New Hamburg Firebirds Thanksgiving Food Drive -** October 7-9th. Two shopping carts were filled with non-perishable items. It was a huge success.
- **Remembrance Day -** November 11
- **Winter Concert -** feedback from the staff is that they want to do one, but don't have details yet. Past years it was the Tuesday before the final week of school (~Dec 10)
- **Field Trips:** Grade 3/4 & 4/5 trip for Wilmot Agricultural Society Education Day on September 20th
- -Grade 5/6 Science trip - October 7th
- **Book Fair -** November 4-8th
- **Halloween -** still waiting from board to see what the direction is, but if no direction then OK with costumes, no masks or weapons.

- **Action Items:**

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7. School Improvements

- Air Conditioning in special education resource room completed
- **Action Items:**

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8. Volunteers Update

- New Dundee Volunteer package - Police Check and volunteer package required in order to volunteer. Contact the office for forms or more information
- **Action Items:**

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9. EQAO

- Spring 2024 EQAO individual student results were sent home the week of October 7th. Overall results were also viewed and analyzed by staff during the October 11th PD Day.
- Did quite well as a school, but the board overall didn't do well in math. There is a push for math programming and strategies in assessment.
- All staff have goals to improve professional practices, to serve students that are underserved and to reduce learning gaps, impacting their students for the better. Staff have picked their school improvement ideas.
- Large focus on literacy
- **Action Items:**

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10. Gardens (Front, Student Vegetable)

- Butterfly Waystation update (Sarah C)
    - School applies for it with a teacher lead and an eco group to run it
    - Next Monday people coming from the outdoor education center and facilities center to assess if we have a Butterfly Waystation, determine, register, and signage.
    - Ms. Wilson will be the rep and her students will be the Butterfly team overseeing this initiative.
    -

- **Action Items:**

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11. Grade six transition planning

- Deferred to January agenda

- **Action Items:**

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12. PD Day

- October 11th PD Day - teaching staff worked on school improvement, other staff were off-site for job-specific training
    - So students that don't fall through the gaps as we know COVID had an impact on all kids
- -Friday, November 1st PD Day - Agenda to be determined, union driven agenda
- **Action Items:**

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13. Nutrition for Learning

- **Here's the Nutrition for Learning Parent Council Information Package**
- Anita Cressman coordinating this program. It is up and running. N4L may require more money.
- Fundraising amount expectation - not specified, but one fundraiser per year was recommended. doesn't have to be through the school, could be through the committee
- Last year Angie reached out to local business and clubs that donated to $1,500 and then school provided $500
- Bethel church wants to support NFL, and wants to give $1,500 toward NDPS. Said they could help us with a fundraiser as well.
- More food is being is consumed this year, and NFL has fewer resources this year.
- Food is purchased from NFL website. Anyone can donate on the website to a specific school, but it is unknown right now if parents can bring in food to the program. Do not think parents can donate food directly to the program.
- **Action Items:**
    - Anita will come back in the Spring for an update, for 2x per year updates
    - Angie to send Anita email from last year
    - Kelly to get thank you card to Bethel church

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14. Strong Start

- Ms. Ferreira, our Special Education Resource Teacher, will begin to look for Strong Start volunteers late this Fall. The program will likely start in January 2025.
    - Volunteers will work with Kindergartens and Grade 1 on literacy
    - Kelly is trained to be a coordinator
- **Action Items:**
    - Craig and Kelly to reach out to Ms. Ferreira

15. Playground Structure Update

- All three play structures were inspected the week of September 30th and no repairs were required (passed the inspection). Mr. Bell reached out to the Facilities Manager, who then reached out to a maintenance foreperson in Facility Services to determine the lifespan of the structures. From a 2023 inspection, it was determined that the life expectancy of the structures is 5-10 years. The Kindergarten play structure is quite new. The red “Junior” play structure is approximately 14 years old. The oldest play structure that is shaped like a tractor is a classic playground that is approximately 24 years old. The Facilities Department is receiving many questions about the lifespan of play structures, and is currently working to determine how to support this process.
- WRAPSC said to start a school council budget line for play structure replacement
- Process to replace or build playground is enormous and has to go through union approved contractors
- **Action Items:**
    - Discuss how much money to set aside for a new play structure next meeting

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16. Class Shuffling Update

- Over 50% of school board went through this, and it came down to funding but WRAPSC will tell us more at the November meeting
- WRAPSC wants to go back to Trustee and say shuffling should happen before Sep 30
- **Action Items:**
    - For parents to email school chair to ask for more clarity and for shuffling to happen before Sep 30

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17. Educators Wish List

- Musical resources Inventory
- Musical instruments - 1 large xylophone is needed. Our current xylophone is quite old and is missing a key/bar. As well, at least two of our indigenous hand drums need to be repaired (more investigation is necessary as these instruments cannot go to a music store to be fixed). More investigation is necessary for both of these instruments. Large xylophones usually start at around $600.

Gym equipment purchased/replaced?

- Update: Gym and classroom equipment was purchased and is currently in use. This purchase was covered by School Funds instead of WEFI because we had extra money. However, this money is still allocated to gym equipment so we may want to look at other purchases including outdoor metal basketball nets/mesh, outdoor basketball nets, and shelving in the gym storage room. Mr. McKenzie is in charge of the gym equipment, so he is going to investigate this more.
- Pickleball is becoming popular at other schools
- Craig is looking into getting the tarmac redone (new four-square painting, leveling out, etc.)
- **Action Items:**
    - Craig to see if gym storage updates is included in gym equipment expenses
    - Craig to talk to Mr. McKenzie about pickleball
    - Mini basketball hoops for younger kids, Craig to find out if kids still want this
    - Craig is looking into four-square repainting

18. Financial Report

SCHOOL COUNCIL FINANCES			
October 16, 2024			
OPENING BALANCE IN 850 ACCOUNT			$3,169.88
DEPOSITS			
Dep #	Date	Description	Amount
59	October 8/24	Herrle's Harvest box Fundraiser-$4515.00	CA$4,384.06
		Repayment from the NFL donation (will show in our interentity later	CA$1,000.00
Total Deposits in 850 Account			$5,384.06
EXPENSES			
Paid by:	Date	Description	Amount
Ck #131561	Oct 8/24	Paid to Herrles for Harvest Box Fundraiser	$3,612.00
Ck#131563	Oct 10/24	Paid to Nutrition for Learning - donations from dance-a-thon 2024, as per January 29/24 minutes	$1,000.00
Total Expenses in 850 Account			$4,612.00
BALANCE IN 850 ACCOUNT			$3,941.94

WEFI ACCOUNT-Opening Balance			$7,957.61
DEPOSITS			
Dep #	Date	Description	Amount
		Total Deposits	$0.00

EXPENSES			
Request Type	Date	Description	Amount
WEFI Reimbursement-Sept	Oct 1/24	School Specialty Recess Equipment-ordered in May	551.33
WEFI Reimbursement-Oct	October 10/24	NFL donation amount from 2024 Dance-a-thon for ck #131563	1000.00
		Total Expenses	$1,551.33
		BALANCE IN WEFI ACCOUNT	$6,406.28

New Dundee P.S

School Council Finances

September 18, 2023

		Description	Deposit	Withdrawal	Balance
		Opening Balance (from June 2023 Report)			2082.99
DEP#	DATE	DEPOSITS			
				TOTAL DEPOSITS	$0.00
Ck #	DATE	WITHDRAWALS			
	Sept 11 from May purchase	Recess Sports Equipment, Council paying half		$324.00	
	Sept 11 from June	Outing for Rms 1 and 2		$254.89	
				TOTAL WITHDRAWALS	$578.89
		CLOSING BALANCE			$1,504.10
		WEFI ACCOUNT	*Deposit*	*Withdrawal*	*Balance*
		Balance from Previous Month			*5943.9*
	Sept 11- from May purchase	Head Protectors purchased from School Specialty		128.95	
				TOTAL Withdrawal	*128.95*
				TOTAL Deposit	*0*
		Reminder: This is the total in WEFI which includes donations and other deposits.		*WEFI Balance*	*5814.95*

- **Funds Voted to Spend:** n/a
- **Grants - WRAPSC - Parent Reaching Out Grant $500**

- **PIC - Grant**
- **$140.82 in the School Council Float**

Action item:

- January to discuss where PIC funds will go

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19. Fundraising Plan for 2024/2025

- **Veggie Boxes:** September (Sarah C Update)
    - Sold 129, earning $903
- **Bookfair**: November
    - Scholastic points are used to purchase items for the school, determined by the staff
- **Coffee:** December
    - Order due date is November 14
    - Gave them our drink selection (regular coffee, vanilla hazelnut, decaf coffee, peppermint tea, and hot chocolate)
    - Give orders to kids directly instead of parent pick-up
- **Dance-A-Thon:** February
- **Chocolate Sales:** March
- **Garden Centre:** April/May

- **Action Items:**
    - Sarah C to draft up form for coffee fundraiser
    - Craig to send out email Nov 7
    - Craig to send Sarah school logo and print sticker that says “thanks for supporting NDPS”
- **Many hands make light work. Please let us know if you are able to help run any fundraisers.**

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20. WRAPSC Meeting Update

- Next meeting is scheduled for November 5th. Please notify Angie if you would like to attend with her ahallmanrmt@gmail.com or ndpscouncil@gmail.com
- Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (WRAPSC)
- Facilities, playgrounds - Start a budget line for structure replacement planning
- Admin to provide regular reporting on maintenance
- Trustee draft letter (vote will happen at next WRAPSC meeting)

    - More cases where kids are being evacuated from classrooms and kids are numb about it or kids don't want to go to school.
    - WRAPSC members wanted the Trustee to provide letters to admin that can get sent home to parents so they know what's happening in the students' classroom. Issue is lack of funding for EA for preventative measures and the current system is reactive. These letters can be used to help get more funding.
- Lock Down / Fire Drill - Request for communication on school day to discuss the events that evening with children
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- **Action Items:**
    - General consensus to support the Trustee draft letter, Angie to take this back to WRAPSC

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21. Items Added by Council Members

- **Hot Lunch Program:**
- Craig - Common allergens from each food supplier that provide us hot lunch
- Craig - What is going on with the Turmeric now that they have sold the business
    - Current dishes will be phased out and replaced by a new restaurant called Frickin' Chicken. 2 month phasing out process.
    - Still trying to get information and connect with the new owner and know the menu
- Survey questions for council feedback before circulation to the broader community.

Hot Lunch Program Survey

As parents and guardians, you know your children's needs and preferences best. When it comes to hot lunch programs, it's essential that parents and guardians are involved in selecting food options for their children. By giving you the opportunity to provide feedback, we can provide meal options that children are more likely to enjoy, helping them stay energized and focused throughout the day. Your input is invaluable in shaping a program that works for everyone.

School council is gathering information and we would appreciate your feedback. Please take a moment to answer the following questions to help guide the decisions made.

1. **How likely are you to participate in a hot lunch program for your child(ren)?**
    - Very likely
    - Somewhat likely
    - Not likely
2. **How many days a week would you like the hot lunch program to be offered?**
    - 1 time a week
    - 2 times a week
    - 3 times a week

    - I would not participate
3. **What types of meals would your child prefer? (Check all that apply)**
    - Chicken strips
    - Pasta dishes (e.g., butter pasta, spaghetti)
    - Sandwiches/wraps
    - Pizza
    - Salads, fruit (e.g., Caesar, garden salad
    - Other (please specify): _____
4. **Would you like to see healthy snack options included with the meals (e.g., fruit, veggies)?**
    - Yes
    - No
5. **What price range do you feel is reasonable for a hot lunch? (Per meal)**
    - 3$-$5
    - $5–$7
    - $7–$9
    - $9–$12
6. **Would you prefer to see a rotation of different restaurants through the school year or to stick to one provider?**
    - Rotation of different restaurants
    - Stick with the same options in the school year
7. **Are there any specific dietary preferences or restrictions we should consider for your child? (e.g., vegetarian, gluten-free, religious)**
    - Yes (please specify): _____
    - No
8. **Any additional feedback or suggestions regarding the hot lunch program?**

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- **Action Items:**
    - January timing of survey
- Here is the link that will show other possible food choices. https://www.esns.ca

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22. Items Added by Council Members:

- **Action Items:**

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23. 2024 / 2025 School Council Dates

- September 16th
- October 21st (7 p.m. - Election/Roles Vote)
- November 25th

- January 27th
- February 24th
- April 21st
- May 26th

- **Action Items:**
- Please email Craig and Angie with any questions and your intent to fill/run for a position on school council. ahallmanrmt@gmail.com and craig_bell@wrdsb.ca
- Here is a link to the handbook School Council Handbook it contains the description of each roll.

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24. Care Committee:

Dedicated to supporting the well-being of members through acts of kindness, empathy, and practical assistance. The committee's primary goal is to foster a compassionate environment where people feel cared for and supported during times of need, whether due to celebrations or personal challenges. Coordinating gestures: Sending cards, flowers, or small gifts to show care and support during life events and calendar celebrations. Collecting donations from the community is part of this role as it can not be covered by school council funds.

- Kelly Willig - Please provide update on care events
    - Al was back the next day and got his get well card
    - Custodian day - two cards out
    - Upcoming: Teacher, Librarian, Bus driver appreciation, ECE, Holiday cards

Action Items:

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25. Meeting Minutes

- **Moved By:** Sarah Cherry
- **Seconded By:** Sarah Benn

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26. Agenda Items for next meeting:

Please email the chair or administration with any agenda requests before the next meeting: ndpscouncil@gmail.com & craig_bell@wrdsb.ca